

Pop-Music Arrangement Unit Plan Band 9

Unit Rationale

Music is a powerful and expressive art form that relies on the interplay of the senses. This unit on arranging a pop song for a small instrumental ensemble is designed to develop students' creative thinking, collaboration, and technical skills. At the same time, it fosters their personal and cultural identities. Through exploration, performance, and reflection, students will gain practical experience in both traditional and digital music creation.

In today's musical landscape, the ability to arrange music is an essential skill for musicians, whether they are performers, composers, or educators. Arranging allows students to explore musical creativity by modifying existing works, making artistic choices, and developing an understanding of instrumentation and orchestration. By working with familiar pop music, students engage in a process that connects to their musical interests and experiences.

This unit supports students in learning how to adapt a melody to different instrumental settings while considering harmony, rhythm, dynamics, and texture. By using MuseScore and live performance settings, students will explore traditional and modern music notation software while arranging. The process encourages them to take creative risks, refine their musical skills, and develop confidence in their ability to organize sound into meaningful artistic expressions.

Curricular Connections

UNDERSTAND

Big Idea

- Music is a process that relies on the interplay of the senses
- Individual and collective expression is rooted in history, culture, and community.

Essential Questions (2-3)

- How do we balance personal expression while staying true to the original song?
- Why is teamwork so important in music making?
- How does arranging a piece of music differ from composing or performing it?

DO	Curricular Competencies Explore and Create ● Perform in large ensemble, small ensemble, and solo contexts ● Improvise and take creative risks in music Reason and Reflect ● Consider the function of their voice within the ensemble Communicate and Document ● Document and share musical works and experiences in a variety of contexts Connect and Expand ● Use technical knowledge and contextual observation to make musical decisions
KNOW	Content learning standards ● musical elements, principles, vocabulary, symbols, and theory ● techniques and technical skills to support creative processes ● hardware and software used to create, record, and structure sound ● characteristics, qualities, and limitations of instruments ● movement, sound, image, and form ● traditional and contemporary First Peoples worldviews and cross-cultural perspectives, as communicated through music ● artists from a variety of genres, contexts, periods, and cultures ● ethics of cultural appropriation and plagiarism
FIRST PEOPLES' PRINCIPLES OF LEARNING	● Learning involves patience and time ● Learning requires the exploration of one's identity ● Learning is reflexive, reflective, experiential, and relational (focused on connectedness, reciprocal relationships, and a sense of place)
UDL/ DIFFERENTIATION	- Students with difficulty reading music: Use chord symbols, graphic notation, or color-coded notes. - Students with fine motor challenges: Allow them to focus on arranging without performing. - English Language Learners (ELLs): Provide bilingual glossaries of music terms, visual aids, and extra listening examples. - Students with attention challenges: Break tasks into smaller

	steps with checkpoints.
Specific Instructional Activities	● Arranging familiar tunes ● Notation using Musescore ● Song history summary ● Class discussion ● Exit Slips ● Song Evaluation worksheet ● Theory Worksheet
ASSESSMENTS	● Pop-Music Song Arrangement ● Performance and notated arrangement

Lesson Plan #1: Band 9 Pop-Music Unit Plan:
Introduction to Arranging Pop Music

Skills/Subjects to be Learned:

- Describe and define characteristics of pop music arrangements
- Identify basic song structure and instrumentation
- Create simple arrangement ideas with familiar tunes

Grade Level: Grade 9

Note: Students will already have a pre-existing knowledge on song form structure

Objectives:

1. Given a demonstration, discussion, and guided practice, the grade 9 student will demonstrate the ability to arrange simple familiar tunes as assessed by an arranged tune using criteria discussed as a class. (Satisfactory/ Not Satisfactory)
2. Given a demonstration, discussion, and guided practice, the grade 9 student will demonstrate the ability to play their arrangements in small groups of 3-4, as assessed by an in-class performance of their arranged familiar tune. (Satisfactory/ Not Satisfactory)

Equipment & Resources:

- Stereo/Sound System
- Recordings of musical pieces:

Instrumental Arrangements

Stand by Me arr. Alexandra Ilieva <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qafTgd4e2TI>

Havana by Camila Cabello arr. Seb Skelly <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EKzg5FTc5-M>

- Musical instruments (clarinet, saxophone, trumpet, trombone, french horn etc.)
- Overhead projection of musical terms: Pre-Chorus, Chorus, Verse, Bridge
- Whiteboard/whiteboard markers

Methodology:

Anticipatory set:

- As the Ss. funnel into class have a pop song cover/ arrangement playing.
- Have either projected or definitions written on the board

Introduction: “Today we will start our pop-music arrangement unit! We will review the pop music structure, and create simple arrangements of simple tunes we already know.”

Definitions:

Pop Music Arranging: Taking an existing song and deciding how it should sound—what instruments play, how the song is structured, and the overall vibe.

Difference from Composing: You’re not writing the song, but shaping how it’s presented.

Lecture/Demonstration/Guided Practice:

- After AS. Ask Ss. “Have you heard any arrangements of songs you like? How do you think an arrangement is different than the original? What makes that version good?”
- Gather Ss. ideas and write them on the board
- The Ss. and T. analyze a pop song arrangement together and see if those elements they brainstormed appear in another arrangement.

Lecture/Demonstration

- T. will play different songs with different structures
 - *(Verse- Chorus-Verse-Chorus-Bridge-Chorus)*
 - *(Verse-Verse-Bridge-Verse AABA)*
 - *(Verse - Chorus- Verse - Chorus ABAB)*
 - Ask Ss. for each example to clap when they hear the chorus, snap on the verse and then stomp on the bridge. (will help students feel the structure) (Have the instructions written on the board as well)
- In pairs Ss. (Think-Pair-Share) will go through these questions and then discuss them as a class after 10 minutes.
 - What is the difference between a chorus and a verse?
 - What is the purpose of a bridge?
 - Do you remember the chorus or the verse more?

Lecture/Demonstration/Guided Practice:

- T. will use the YouTube recordings found above. Play (small snippets of the tune 30sec - 1 min)
- T. will introduce Pop arrangement essentials
 - Rhythm section: Drums, bass guitar
 - Melody/ Harmony: keyboards, trumpet, saxophone
 - Vocals: Lead and backing vocals (can be played on band instrument)
- Have Ss. analyze and listen to the arrangement and the original songs in small groups of 3-4.
 - Ask the Ss. to think about why the artist did that in their version.
 - Discuss the differences in form, instrumentation, style, and interpretation and why the artist made certain changes if they did.

Guided Practice:

- Ss. will create an arrangement with the T. as a class using students' suggestions and the ideas curated by the students on a simple song like “Twinkle Twinkle Little Star” or another familiar tune; using a general framework
 - What instruments will play the melody?
 - What instruments will play the chords (root notes)
 - Do we need to add drums?
- Ask Ss. and let them decide on different instruments for melody etc.
 - “What if we made this a rock song?”

Independent Practice:

- In small groups of 3-4, students will pick from a list of familiar tunes like “Row Row Your Boat” and arrange it with their instruments in the group. (T. monitors and provides help if necessary.)

Closure:

- Ss. present their arrangements to the class.

- Ask the Ss. to actively listen to their peers' performances for the criteria we discussed earlier. After each performance Ss. will give peer feedback to the groups.

Formal Assessment:

Note: This is one lesson in a larger unit plan focusing on arranging where at the end of the unit students will perform or play an audio recording of their arrangement to the class. Will be assessed by a final rubric from the teacher and receive teacher and peer feedback

Lesson Plan #2: **Music Notation Software**

Learning Objective: Given in-class lecture, demonstration, and guided practice, the student will demonstrate the ability to use Musescore to transcribe a popular song melody for their instrument(s) with a project submission at the end of the lesson which will be evaluated by Satisfactory/ Not Satisfactory with less than 3 notation errors (such as pitch, dynamic, tempo, articulation, instrument, etc.).

Note: This lesson will require 2-3 classes.

Pre-knowledge:

- Knowledge of basic operations
- Knowledge about technology.
- Knowledge of regular music notation symbols and rules.

Materials:

- Laptops or access to computer lab

Anticipatory Set:

- The teacher will demonstrate their arrangement of popular music by showing the midi workspace.
- The teacher will introduce what is music notation software and different variations of notation software

Lecturing:

- The teacher will introduce the basic information about Musescore.
- The teacher will discuss how to create a new project on Musescore and how to choose instruments, tempo, key signature, and instrument order.
- Then the teacher will introduce how to notate pitches, rhythm, dynamics, articulation, and accidentals.

Guided Practise:

- Students will be directed to transcribe melodies from the board to Musescore with different instruments. The teacher will monitor students and apply for assistance if needed.

Lecturing:

- The teacher will now introduce how to change the key, instrument, and format in Musescore.

- The teacher will also teach students how to add musical elements to their composition.

Independent Practice:

- The teacher will introduce their assignment and students will work on it for the remainder of the class. The teacher will assist if needed.

Closure:

- T. will give students a brief review of materials learned in the class
- Then the teacher will remind students of their assignment for this lesson.

Assessment:

- Students will submit their projects at the end of the lesson period. Students are asked to transcribe a popular song melody into an instrument solo for their main instrument(s) with no more than 3 notation errors. (Satisfactory/ Not Satisfactory).

Lesson Plan #3:
How to choose a workable song

Skills/Subjects to be Learned:

- How to determine if a pop song is suitable for arranging for their playing abilities
- Develop the ability to identify harmony, melody and bass line
- Basic music theory (Common chord progressions)

Grade Level: Grade 9

Objectives:

Given a demonstration, discussion and guided practice, the grade 9 student will demonstrate the ability to choose and evaluate a pop song suitable for arranging as assessed by a written, short reflection based on the provided criteria. (Satisfactory/ Not Satisfactory)
(Satisfactory/ Not Satisfactory)

Equipment & Resources:

- Stereo/Sound System
- Musical instruments (clarinet, saxophone, trumpet, trombone, french horn etc.)
- Recordings of musical pieces:

Let It Be by the Beatles <https://youtu.be/CGj85pVzRJs?si=mjxjn5kqgpENhPz3>

- Whiteboard/whiteboard markers

Methodology:

Anticipatory set:

- At the beginning of class play the game “Guess the Arrangement.”
 - Play short excerpts of popular songs they know that have been arranged into different styles (eg. a pop song turned into an upbeat swing)
 - have the Ss. guess both the original song and the style it has been arranged.
 - After discussing their reactions – ‘what makes some songs work well in different styles while others sound awkward?’

Introduction: “Today we will be learning how to choose a workable song to arrange! We will review what to look for in the songs we want to play, determine if this song is achievable and discuss why some songs are easier to arrange than others.

Lecture/Demonstration/Guided Practice:

- T. will discuss criteria to consider when selecting a pop song for arranging for a small band ensemble:
 - *Melody:* Is it singable and clear?
 - *Harmony:* Are the chords relatively simple, or are they too complex for a beginning arrangement?
 - *Instrumentation:* Can the song be played and adapted to different instruments?
 - *Rhythm and Tempo:* Is the rhythm accessible and playable on your ensemble's instruments?
 - *Form and Structure:* Does the song have a clear verse-chorus format that makes arranging a song easier?

Demonstration

- T. will play a recording of Let It Be by the Beatles and do a breakdown of what to hear as that song is easy to listen to the different components.
- T. will then play each component starting with the harmony of: C G Am F
- T. will play the melody and show that stepwise motion makes it easy to sing or play
 - The simpleness of the song makes it easy to arrange for different instrumentation

Guided Practice:

- T. will divide the students into small groups and provide them with a list of pre-selected pop songs
- Each group will choose one song from the list and analyze it using the given criteria
 - Song Evaluation Worksheet
- Groups will present their song choice and provide their justification on why or why it is not a good song to arrange for a grade 9 small ensemble.
- T. will walk around and monitor each group's progress and provide support if necessary.

Independent Practice:

- Ss. will find a song they want to arrange, either for the final project or a song they are interested in at the moment and evaluate it.
- They will complete their Song evaluation worksheet, justifying their selection.

Closure:

- “Good job today! That was a lot of information to take in! But as we can see there are many checkpoints that we have to check to decide if this is suitable for a small ensemble.
- Students will submit an exit slip on their way out.
 - “What is one key factor in choosing a song for arranging?”
 -

Formal Assessment:

- The student will be asked to individually submit a *Song Evaluation Worksheet* that will include questions on why they chose the song, what is the background of the song, the components of the song they chose and if the song is suitable for their small ensemble. (Satisfactory/ Not Satisfactory)

Band 9

Song Evaluation Worksheet

Choose a song that is suitable for either your arrangement group project or a song you would like to do, use this checklist and ensure that each question is answered with a justification.

Song name: _____ **Composer/ Artist:** _____ **Genre:** _____

Song Background:

Write a brief summary of any history or information about the song your choice.

Why did you select this song?

What challenges might arise in arranging this song?

1. Chord Progression:

Is the chord progression simple and not too complex? Is it easy to play?

2. Melody Playability:

Is the melody singable? Are you able to play it on your own instrument?

3. Rhythm & Tempo:

How fast is the song? If so, does it need to be adjusted to your level? Are the rhythms syncopated?

4. Instrumentation

Is the song adaptable to different instruments?

5. Form and Structure

Is the road map for the song clear and traditional verse-chorus format? Or is it unconventional?

Lesson Plan #4:

Introduction to instrumentation (instrument characteristics, quality, limitation)

Learning Objective: Given in-class lecture, demonstration, guided practice, and independent practice, the student will demonstrate the ability to describe the characteristics, quality, and limitations of different instruments and the ability to orchestrate different instruments into one multi-instrument arrangement, is assessed by an instrumentation project at the end of the lesson that the student is required to arrange a passage of popular music with at least 3 different kinds of instruments included in the arrangement with less than 5 notation errors (pitch, dynamic, tempo, articulation, instrumentation errors, and instrument limitation and rules) to achieve a passing grade.

Note: this lesson requires 3 classes.

Pre-knowledge:

- Knowledge of how to use Musescore or other music notation software.
- Knowledge of regular music notation symbols and rules.
- Sufficient skill on at least one instrument.

Materials:

- Laptops or access to computer lab
- Student's instrument (if needed)

Anticipatory Set:

- The teacher will demonstrate their more detailed pop music arrangement from lesson 2 with additional instruments.
- The teacher will introduce the purpose of instrumentation and give an overview of the lesson.

Lecturing:

- First, the teacher will let students listen to the sound of each instrument through an external video.
- Then, the teacher will give an introduction to those band instruments about their characteristics and function in the band.
- After that, the teacher will explain the rules, limitations, and restrictions for each instrument so students can arrange playable music.
- Then, the teacher will introduce the concept of transposition instruments and some of the common transpositions, such as Bb instruments and Eb instruments (maybe F instruments).
- The teacher will briefly mention methods on how to balance different instruments. For example, when there is a flute, clarinet, and trumpet, the flute and clarinet can double the

melody while the trumpet plays the countermelody. Or the trumpet could drop in dynamic to balance with the flute and/or clarinet.

Demonstration:

- After giving brief instructions on instrument balancing, the teacher will demonstrate how to balance different instruments using a short passage of pop music.

Guided Practise:

- The teacher will hand out a short music passage with melody and harmony. students are asked to use clarinet, trumpet, and tuba to make a simple arrangement of the passage.
- This activity is an in-class activity and will not count toward the final assignments of the lesson.
- At the end of the activity, the teacher will display their arrangement and explain the rationale of different orchestration decisions.

Independent Practice:

- Students are now required to make another arrangement using the same passage but with tuba/bari sax and two other instruments (cannot be clarinet+trumpet combination)
- This activity is not part of the lesson's final assignment, but completion is required to move on to the final assignment.

Closure:

- T. will give students a brief review of materials learned in the class
- Then the teacher will remind students of their assignment for this lesson.

Assessment:

- The student is required to arrange a passage of popular music, that is chosen from a given list, with at least 3 different kinds of instruments included in the arrangement with less than 5 notation errors(pitch, dynamic, tempo, articulation, instrumentation errors, and instrument limitation and rules) to achieve passing grade.

Lesson Plan #5: (skeleton)

Where does the core of pop music come from?

Learning Objectives

SWBAT:

1. Identify the historical roots and key influences of pop music.
2. Explore how different genres (rock, blues, jazz, folk, hip-hop, etc.) have shaped modern pop music.
3. Analyze key characteristics that define pop music, including melody, harmony, rhythm, and lyrical content.

Lecture/Demonstration

Provide a brief historical overview:

- Early pop influences: Blues, Jazz, Rock & Roll, Motown.
- Evolution through the decades: 1960s-70s rock/pop (The Beatles, ABBA), 1980s-90s synth-pop (Madonna, Michael Jackson), 2000s digital production (Beyoncé, Taylor Swift).
- The role of technology (radio, TV, streaming services) in shaping pop music trends.

Discuss the defining features of pop music:

- Simple, memorable melodies.
- Strong rhythmic foundation (often danceable).
- Repetitive structures (verse-chorus format).
- Lyrical themes of love, personal struggles, and social issues.

Guided Practice

Break students into small groups. Assign each group a different decade of pop music (1960s-2020s). Have them listen to a song from that era and identify:

- The melody and harmony.
- Rhythmic characteristics.
- Instrumentation.
- Lyrical content.

Ask them to research on this song and create a short write-up on:

- What genres influenced this song?
- What musical characteristics does it share with past pop songs?

Assessment: Class discussion and group participation.

Lesson Plan #6:
Basic Music Theory (Scales, Chords, Musical Form)

Objective

Given teacher-led demonstrations and discussions on basic music theory concepts (scales, chords, and musical form), along with guided practice in analyzing a simple pop song and constructing a chord progression, the student will **demonstrate the ability to:**

1. Accurately write out one major scale and its relative minor (using the correct key signature)
2. Build triads in that key (with correct chord spelling)
3. Identify and label the form (verse, chorus, bridge) of a chosen pop song.

The student will be evaluated by the teacher using a rubric for accuracy (at least 80% correct in each component) and consistency (Satisfactory/Not Satisfactory).

Equipment

- Classroom instruments (e.g., piano, guitars, percussion, or other available band instruments)
- Computer and projector for demonstration
- Music software (Musescore)
- Student notebooks or workbooks for theory exercises
- Pre-selected examples of simple pop songs (e.g., songs with basic chord progressions)

Anticipatory Set

Begin the lesson by playing a simple pop song (e.g., “Let It Be”) on the piano or through speakers. Ask the students “What makes this song work musically? What is happening with the melody, harmony, and structure?” Then, show a simplified lead sheet for the song and explain that today’s focus will be learning how to create and analyze similar structures.

Modeling

1. Scales:

Draw a C Major scale on the board. Discuss the pattern of whole and half steps (W-W-H-W-W-W-H); Play the C Major scale on a keyboard or another instrument and have students sing or play along. Briefly explain the difference between major and their relative minor scales, highlighting their emotional impacts (happy vs. sad).

2. Chords:

Demonstrate how triads are built from scales (e.g., I = C-E-G, IV = F-A-C, V = G-B-D). Show students how chord progressions are formed (e.g., I-IV-V-I) and how these progressions are common in pop music. Then, play a simple progression on the piano while singing or playing the melody, linking melody and harmony.

3. Musical Form:

Break down the form of a pop song (e.g., verse-chorus-bridge structure). Display a visual representation (e.g., Verse [A] → Chorus [B] → Verse [A] → Chorus [B] → Bridge [C] → Chorus [B]).

Guided Practice

1. Scales:

Have students write out the C Major scale and construct other major scales using the same whole/half-step pattern. Encourage them to sing or play these scales on their instruments.

2. Chords:

Ask students to build triads from the C Major scale (e.g., C-E-G, D-F-A, E-G-B). Provide a simple chord progression (e.g., C-G-Am-F) and have them play it on their instruments together as a class. Use Musescore to show how the progression looks in notation.

3. Musical Form Activity:

Provide students with a lyric sheet and have them identify the sections (verse, chorus, bridge). Discuss how chords change between sections to create variety and interest.

Independent Practice

Scale Construction: Assign students to write out one major scale and its relative minor.

Chord Progressions: Ask students to create their 4-chord progression in a chosen key.

Form Analysis: Have students listen to a simple pop song of their choice and map its form (e.g., AABA or Verse-Chorus-Bridge).

Closure

Recap the main concepts: scales, chords, and musical form together as a class. Discuss how understanding these elements will help in arranging music for a small ensemble.

Formal Assessment

Theory Worksheet: Collect and evaluate the scale, chord, and progression exercises completed during independent practice.

Form Analysis: Assess students' song maps for accuracy and insight.

Exit Ticket: Ask students to write a short reflection: "What is one thing you learned about music theory today that you can use in your arrangement project?"

Formative Assessment

During the lesson, the teacher will circulate as students work on writing out scales, building chords, and mapping song form. The teacher will provide immediate feedback to correct misunderstandings or reinforce proper techniques.

Lesson Plan #7: (skeleton)
Common Arranging Errors

Learning Objectives

SWBAT:

1. Identify different common arranging errors
2. Know how to fix arranging errors
3. Understand how to avoid arranging errors

Lecture/Demonstration

The teacher will review some of the arranging concepts learned from previous classes.

The teacher provides some examples of arranging errors and explains each mistake.

Guided Practice

The teacher will guide students in a learning activity to identify and fix different arranging mistakes and fix them.

Independent Practice

Students will work on an arranging errors worksheet on their own.

Assessment

Students are asked to submit their worksheet on arranging errors before the next lesson.

Lesson Plan #8: (skeleton)

Copyright

Learning Objectives

SWBAT:

1. Understand the importance of copyright in the music industry.
2. Know how to respect and protect copyright.

Lecture

The teacher will give a brief lecture on copyright history.

The teacher will give a lecture on the importance of copyright.

Discussion

Students will discuss examples of copyright plagiarism in groups and then share to the entire class.

Then students will discuss how to protect copyright in this project.

Assessment

Each student will submit a discussion report at the end of the lesson.

Lesson Plan #9: (skeleton)
Rehearsal Strategies

Learning Objectives

SWBAT:

1. Learn different chamber rehearsal strategies.
2. Understanding a great ensemble is based on solid individual work.
3. Demonstrate leadership and care for other members of the group.
4. Use rehearsal time efficiently.
5. Come up with a rehearsal plan.

Lecture

Provide a brief rehearsal strategies overview:

- Individual practice vs. paired rehearsal vs. whole group rehearsal
- How to have an effective and efficient rehearsal
- How to be a good member of a team

Discussion

Discuss the following topic:

- What are some of the struggles each group/individual is facing
- What can you do to solve those problems
- What plans does each group come up with after today's lecture?

Independent Practice

Students will rehearse in their groups and rehearse their projects.

Closure

Each group summarizes their primary target moving forward and a rehearsal plan as an exit slip.

Assessment

Groups submit exit slips.

Lesson Plan #10: **Project Presentation**

Lesson Objectives

By the end of the lesson, students will:

1. Present their arranged pop songs in a performance or playback format.
2. Explain their arrangement decisions, including instrumentation, harmonization, and stylistic choices.
3. Critically analyze their work and that of their peers, using music vocabulary and concepts.
4. Reflect on their learning process and explore ways to improve their arranging skills in the future.

Equipment

- Projector and speakers (for digital playback, if needed)
- Printed or digital sheet music of student arrangements
- Musical instruments for live performance (if applicable)
- Rubric and feedback sheets for peer and teacher assessment
- Whiteboard and markers for discussion

Anticipatory Set

Agenda Overview: Explain the lesson structure: Presentations, feedback, and reflection.

Emphasize that this is a supportive and constructive session, designed to help them improve as arrangers.

Guided Practice: Peer Feedback Guidelines

Review how to give constructive feedback using music terminology. Discuss evaluation criteria as a class: clarity, instrumentation choices, balance, creativity, and technical accuracy. And hand out a structured peer review sheet to guide comments.

Independent Practice:

Student Presentations

Each student or group introduces their arrangement. They explain key musical decisions: Why they chose their song? How they adapted it for a small ensemble? What techniques they used (e.g., reharmonization, counter-melody, dynamic contrast). Perform the arrangement live or play a digital rendering.

Peer and Instructor Feedback:

Peers provide one strength and one area for improvement using the provided feedback sheets. Instructor gives brief verbal feedback focusing on strengths and suggestions for refinement.

Closure (10 minutes)

1. Reflective Discussion: What was the biggest challenge in arranging? What did you learn about instrumentation and harmony through this process? How would you improve your arrangement if given more time?
2. Final Thoughts: Reinforce the idea that music arranging is an ongoing skill-building process. Encourage students to explore arranging outside of class and use technology as a creative tool.

Curricular Competencies	Emerging	Developing	Proficient	Extending
Improvise and take creative risks in music	Explores simple ideas but stays within the original song with minimal change. Takes few creative risks.	Explores some creative ideas and takes occasional risks, but relies on familiar patterns and structures. Takes some creative risks.	Explores and applies creative ideas, making thoughtful musical choices that enhance the arrangement. Takes risks that demonstrates understanding of musical concepts.	Explores and applies innovative ideas with confidence, reimagines the song in an engaging way. Takes bold creative risks that demonstrates originality and excellent understanding of musical concepts
Perform in small ensemble contexts	Attempts to perform individual part within the small ensemble, with limited musical expression.	Performs individual part within the small ensemble, with some musical expression.	Performs individual part effectively within a small ensemble, with appropriate musical expression.	Performs individual part meaningfully within the small ensemble, with artful and sophisticated musical expression.
Consider the function of their voice within the ensemble	Demonstrates limited understanding of the significance of role within the ensemble by showing limited initiative for individual part.	Demonstrates developing an understanding of the significance of role within the ensemble by beginning to show initiative for individual part.	Demonstrates understanding of the significance of role within the ensemble by showing initiative for individual part.	Demonstrates excellent understanding of the significance of role within the ensemble by showing outstanding initiative for individual part.

Document and share musical works and experiences in a variety of contexts	Arrangement contains minimal detail and limited reflection. Final score of arrangement is unclear or incomplete .	Arrangement contains some detail and reflection. Final score of arrangement is somewhat organized but lacks depth.	Arrangement contains is clear with thoughtful reflection and is well-organized. Final arrangement uses correct formatting and contexts.	Arrangement is rich & detailed with insightful and creative reflection that demonstrates a deep understanding of content. Final arrangement is clear and uses engaging formatting to communicate ideas.
Use technical knowledge and contextual observation to make musical decisions	Demonstrates limited understanding of musical elements (harmony, melody, rhythm, instrumentation) when making arrangement decisions.	Demonstrates some understanding of musical elements and applies them inconsistently . Some technical errors present.	Demonstrates a strong understanding of musical elements and applies them effectively in the arrangement. Minor technical errors.	Demonstrates excellent understanding of musical elements, applying them thoughtfully to enhance the arrangement. Shows deep knowledge of instrumentation, harmony, and orchestration.
Develop appropriate musical vocabulary, skills, and techniques	Score is incomplete or contains many notation errors. Parts are unplayable or do not fit well with the chosen instruments. Lack balance between melody, harmony, and rhythm.	Score is complete but contains some notation errors . Part are playable but range, technique, or orchestration issues make the arrangement challenging to perform. Shows some awareness of balance and texture, but some parts may be too dense or sparse.	Score is clear and well-organized with minimal notation errors . Parts are written effectively for the instruments with appropriate ranges and techniques. Demonstrates good balance of melody, harmony, and rhythm. Clear awareness of texture.	Score is polished with detail and well-organized with no notation errors . Parts are well-orchestrated , maximizing the strength of each instrument. Excellent awareness in balance and texture with sophisticated use of harmonic layering and dynamic shaping.